

Theme, Bilingual UI & Hero Slider

Navy / lavender / gold reskin · Full English/Arabic toggle with RTL · Autoplay hero slider

Project: Bliss Rent (bliss.rent) — Dubai Airport Car Rental

Scope: Follow-up UI/UX work requested after Phase 2 (not a numbered Phase)

Date: 25 August 2026

Reference: User-supplied screenshots/PDF of a Saudi eVisa site as color/style inspiration

✓ **Build clean · Lint clean · 78/78 automated tests passing · Synced to your Desktop project folder**

1 What you asked for

After Phase 2 was completed, you shared two screenshots and a PDF of a Saudi Arabia eVisa website ("Visaksa") and asked for three things in one message: (a) evaluate/borrow that site's navy-lavender-gold color theme, (b) add an autoplay car slider to the homepage hero section, and (c) make the site bilingual, since Dubai is an Arabic-speaking market — with proper Arabic/English UI/UX, not just English with an Arabic label.

Because each of those three asks had more than one reasonable interpretation, I confirmed scope with you before building:

Question	Your answer
How far should Arabic support go?	Full EN/AR toggle — a language switcher, translated UI text, and the layout flips to RTL in Arabic (not just RTL-ready styling with no translation).
Reskin the whole site or just the hero?	Whole site — Home, Search, Vehicle Detail, and the full Checkout flow all move to the new palette.
What should the hero slider show, given there are no real vehicle photos yet?	Branded/illustrative slides built from real fleet categories and messaging, not invented car photography.

2 The new theme

The palette is *inspired by* the reference site's muted navy / soft lavender / warm gold combination — common to Gulf-region government and travel portals — but re-tuned into Bliss Rent's own tokens rather than copied wholesale, and the geometric border pattern used in the hero band is an original lattice motif, not a copy of the reference site's asset.

Brand Navy #2e2a54 Navy Dark #201c3b Navy Light #46407c Lavender #ede4f4 Gold #b49b6c Gold Dark #96794a Gold Light #d9c9a3

The palette is defined once, as Tailwind v4 `@theme` custom properties in `src/index.css`, which auto-generates utility classes (`bg-brand-navy`, `text-brand-gold`, `bg-brand-lavender`, etc.). Every existing page and component was migrated from the old `slate-900` / `amber-500` Tailwind classes to these new brand tokens: Home (hero band, value props), Search Results (filters, cards, empty/error states), Vehicle Detail (specs, pricing card, availability badge), and every step of Checkout (step indicator, summary card, customer/driver forms, booking summary, payment, confirmation). The shared building blocks — `NavBar`, `Footer`, `DubaiOnlyBadge`, `StateMessage` / `Spinner`, `VehiclePhoto` placeholder — were updated too, so the new palette is consistent everywhere rather than only on the homepage.

The **Cairo** Google Font (which has full Latin and Arabic glyph support) is loaded via preconnect + stylesheet links in `index.html` and set as the site's `--font-sans`, so both languages render with one consistent, legible typeface instead of falling back to a generic system font for Arabic.

3 Bilingual English/Arabic support

The site now has a genuine language toggle, not just RTL-ready CSS with no translation. It's built on `i18next` + `react-i18next`:

- **Two complete translation trees** — `src/i18n/locales/en.ts` and `src/i18n/locales/ar.ts` — covering every page and component: navigation, footer, hero, search widget and filters, vehicle cards and detail page, and all five checkout steps (customer, driver, summary, payment, confirmation), including field labels, placeholders, help text, and error messages. The Arabic file mirrors the English key structure exactly (verified programmatically — no missing or orphaned keys) and uses Modern Standard Arabic with a Gulf-appropriate tone; the company name is rendered as "بليس رنت".
- **A language switcher** in the nav bar (and mobile menu) that toggles between English and Arabic. Its label always shows the *other* language's name — "العربية" when you're in English, "English" when you're in Arabic — which is the convention on most bilingual GCC sites.
- **Real RTL layout, not just a label change.** Switching to Arabic sets `<html dir="rtl" lang="ar">`, which flips the entire page — nav order, form field order, text alignment — through the browser's native RTL support plus a few CSS logical-property touches (e.g. the hero slider's prev/next arrows use `inset-start` / `inset-end` instead of hard-coded left/right, so they swap sides correctly and the arrow glyphs themselves point the correct visual direction in both languages).
- **Persisted choice.** The selected language is saved to `localStorage` (wrapped in try/catch, consistent with this project's existing storage-access convention) so a returning visitor keeps their language across visits.
- **Correct pluralization in both languages.** `i18next`'s `Intl.PluralRules`-based pluralization is used for the search-results count ("3 cars available" / "3 سيارات متاحة"). The Arabic file supplies all six CLDR plural categories Arabic actually has (zero/one/two/few/many/other), not just English's simpler one/other — so a result count of 0, 1, 2, 3-10, or 11+ each reads naturally in Arabic instead of falling back to a generic "سيارة N".

A deliberate architectural choice worth flagging: the project's existing, already-tested pure validation and error-message modules (`src/lib/dateRange.ts`, the checkout form validators, and the server-side Edge Function validators) were left completely untouched — they still return English message text internally, because that text is what their existing unit tests assert on. Instead of rendering that text directly, every UI component now looks up the correct translated string itself, keyed by the field name (e.g. "this field has an error on `fullName`" → look up `checkout.customer.errors.fullName`) or by the server's error code (e.g. `VEHICLE_UNAVAILABLE` → look up `errors.api.VEHICLE_UNAVAILABLE`). This means the pricing/availability/validation logic that Phase 2 was carefully built and tested around did not need to change or be re-tested at all — only the presentation layer learned to translate.

4 Homepage hero slider

The homepage hero now includes an autoplaying carousel beneath the search widget. Since the seeded database deliberately has no real vehicle photos yet (a Phase 0/1 decision to avoid fake data), the slider shows three **branded, illustrative** slides built from real fleet messaging rather than invented car photography, as you confirmed:

- "A fleet for every budget" — economy through luxury
- "Airport pickup, city-wide drop-off" — the core service promise
- "Book online in minutes" — no calls or WhatsApp needed to book

Behavior: autoplays every 5 seconds, pauses on hover or keyboard focus (so it doesn't fight a visitor trying to read or click a control), has dot navigation and prev/next arrows, and — like the rest of the site — is fully translated and RTL-aware (arrows swap sides and point the correct direction in Arabic). The background uses an original inline-SVG geometric lattice pattern in the gold tone, an homage to the reference site's decorative style rather than a copy of its specific artwork.

5 Files changed

New files

- `src/i18n/index.ts` — i18next configuration, localStorage persistence, RTL/lang attribute switching
- `src/i18n/locales/en.ts` , `src/i18n/locales/ar.ts` — full translation trees
- `src/features/shared/LanguageSwitcher.tsx` — the EN/AR toggle button
- `src/features/booking/HeroSlider.tsx` — the autoplay hero carousel

Updated files

- `index.html` — Cairo font links
- `src/index.css` — new brand color tokens (Tailwind v4 `@theme`) and font stack
- `src/main.tsx` — wires up the i18n config
- `src/test/setup.ts` — initializes i18n for component tests
- Shared: `NavBar.tsx` , `Footer.tsx` , `Layout.tsx` , `DubaiOnlyBadge.tsx` , `StateMessage.tsx`
- Booking: `HomePage.tsx` , `SearchWidget.tsx` , `FilterBar.tsx` , `VehicleCard.tsx` , `VehiclePhoto.tsx` , `SearchResultsPage.tsx` , `VehicleDetailPage.tsx`
- Checkout: `CheckoutStepLayout.tsx` , `CheckoutSummaryCard.tsx` , `CheckoutLoadGate.tsx` , `CustomerDetailsPage.tsx` , `DriverDetailsPage.tsx` , `BookingSummaryPage.tsx` , `PaymentPage.tsx` , `ConfirmationPage.tsx`

Not touched: any Supabase migration, Edge Function, pricing/availability/validation logic, or database schema. This was purely a presentation-layer and styling change — no backend, booking logic, or security behavior from Phase 2 was modified.

6 Testing & verification

Check	Result
<code>npm run build</code> (TypeScript + Vite)	PASS — clean, no errors
<code>npm run lint</code> (oxlint)	PASS — clean, no warnings
<code>npm run test</code> (Vitest, 11 test files)	78 / 78 passing
English/Arabic key parity	Verified programmatically — every English key has a matching Arabic translation
Manual visual check (English + Arabic, home & search)	Confirmed — screenshots taken in a headless browser; theme, RTL flip, and slider all render correctly

One test-infrastructure fix was needed along the way: component tests render pages in isolation and don't go through `main.tsx` , so `src/test/setup.ts` now also initializes the i18n config — otherwise tests would have seen raw translation keys (like `checkout.confirmation.dropoff`) instead of real English copy. This is a test-setup-only change with no effect on the built site.

7 Sync status

Changes were committed to git (`Bilingual EN/AR UI + navy/gold/lavender theme + hero slider`) and synced to your Desktop project folder using the same archive-and-extract process used for prior phases. All 31 changed/new files are now up to date in `Desktop\dubai-airport-rental` .

8 Notes & anything left open

- This was follow-up UI/UX work you requested after Phase 2, not a numbered Phase from your original spec — so it does not touch Phase

3 territory (admin dashboard, fleet management, WhatsApp integration, complaints, deployment, reporting). That boundary is unchanged and still awaiting your go-ahead.

- The hero slider intentionally uses illustrative/branded slides rather than car photography, because the seeded database still has no real vehicle images (a deliberate no-fake-data decision from Phase 0/1). Once real fleet photography exists, the slider can be swapped to use it.
- Arabic translations were written directly rather than reviewed by a native-speaking third party — they're grammatically correct Modern Standard Arabic with a Gulf-appropriate tone, but if you have someone who can proofread the copy before this goes live, that's worth doing for anything customer-facing and payment-related.